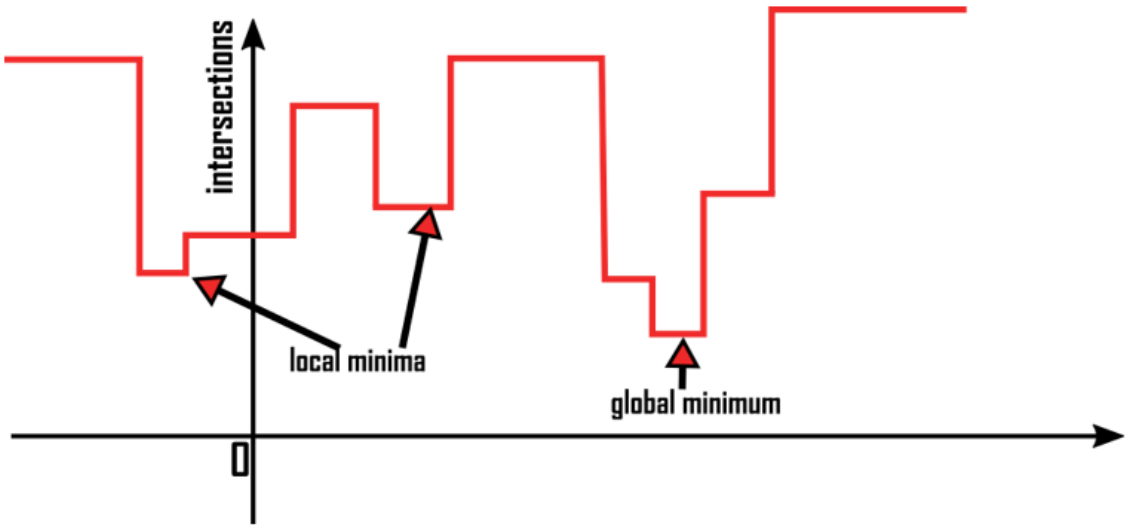


Figure 16.9 Local and global minima in a 1D function.

16.2.2 Step Functions and Local Minima

Local minima aren't really good news: ideally, we would like to have a single global minimum, and a cost function that smoothly converges towards it.

A bowl-shaped function, for example, like the section of conic curve shown in figure 16.9. would suit us particularly well, and work fine with most learning algorithms.

